BRITISH AIRWAYS / SUPERSONIC

DUBAI, REDEFINED
AS A GATEWAY TO ASIA

A proposed British Airways supersonic network concept linking the Gulf to Asia-Pacific at a target cruise of Mach 2.2.



SHANGHAI	≈ 6,449 KM	**MANILA**	≈ 6,906 KM	**SYDNEY**	≈ 12,043 KM

THE DUBAI PROPOSITION

A NEW EASTERN GATEWAY

A Dubai-led operating concept for premium, time-sensitive travel - designed around selective speed, not speed everywhere.

Dubai sits at the intersection of Europe, the Gulf and Asia-Pacific. A future supersonic product could use that geographic position to link major business, technology, trade, finance and family-travel markets with a radically shorter time in the air.

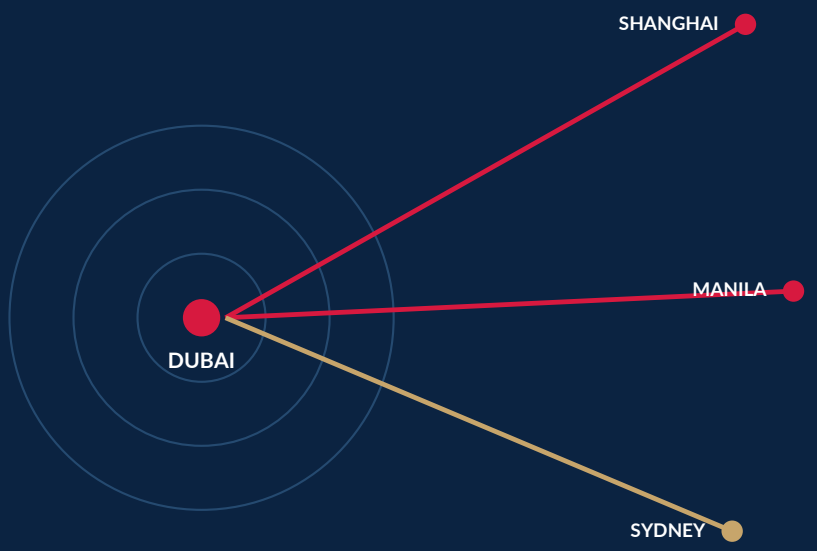
The proposition is deliberately focused: begin with a small number of high-value routes, validate aircraft performance and operating approvals, then expand only where speed creates enough customer and commercial value to justify the extra complexity.

DESIGN PRINCIPLE

Route ambition must follow aircraft capability. Shanghai and Manila are baseline-range evaluation candidates. Sydney is a longer-range flagship or a staged one-stop proposition until the aircraft proves a direct mission with operational reserves.

PROPOSED ROUTE ARCHITECTURE

Dubai as the launch platform



Schematic only - not a flight path or approved airspace corridor.

MACH 2.2
ILLUSTRATIVE CRUISE TARGET

7,400 KM
SUPPLIED CONCEPT BASELINE RANGE

3 ROUTES
ASIA-PACIFIC ROUTE THESIS

THE PORTFOLIO

THREE CITIES. THREE STRATEGIC ROLES.

Indicative distances are great-circle airport-to-airport estimates. Time targets are unvalidated planning hypotheses, not timetables.

PHASE 1 / RANGE EVALUATION

SHANGHAI

PVG • CHINA

6,449 km

CURRENT PUBLISHED NONSTOP BENCHMARK

8h 40m

INDICATIVE MACH 2.2 TARGET

3h 20m - 4h 00m

≈ 4h 40m - 5h 20m potential reduction

A flagship bridge to one of Asia's principal commercial and manufacturing centres. A potential time advantage for leadership travel, capital markets, technology partnerships and high-value

Range note: ~87% of the 7,400 km headline range before reserves, winds, routing and payload effects.

PHASE 1 / TIGHTER RANGE CASE

MANILA

MNL • PHILIPPINES

6,906 km

CURRENT PUBLISHED NONSTOP BENCHMARK

9h 05m

INDICATIVE MACH 2.2 TARGET

3h 35m - 4h 15m

≈ 4h 50m - 5h 30m potential reduction

A high-frequency business, services, family and leisure market. A compelling use case if payload, operating reserves and approved high-speed segments can be reconciled.

Range note: ~93% of headline range before operational allowances; likely the most constrained baseline mission.

PHASE 2 / LONG-RANGE FLAGSHIP

SYDNEY

SYD • AUSTRALIA

12,043 km

CURRENT PUBLISHED NONSTOP BENCHMARK

13h 35m

INDICATIVE MACH 2.2 TARGET

5h 45m - 6h 30m

≈ 7h 05m - 7h 50m potential reduction

The Pacific statement route: a long-range business and premium leisure proposition connecting Australia directly to the Gulf and onward BA network.

Range note: ~163% of headline range. Direct service needs an extended-range aircraft; a staged one-stop product via Singapore is the baseline concept.

Timing basis: optimistic in-flight targets incorporating climb, acceleration, deceleration and slower segments; assumes sufficient approved supersonic operating corridors. Actual times may be materially longer. Not door-to-door savings and not a validated performance forecast.

THE AIRCRAFT AND THE JOURNEY

SPEED, SERVED WITH BRITISH PRECISION

The existing visual is used as the same Mach 2.2 aircraft concept; its figures are illustrative design targets only.



SUPPLIED CONCEPT FIGURES

CRUISE SPEED
Mach 2.2 / ~2,430 km/h

NOMINAL RANGE
7,400 km / typical

LENGTH
88 metres

CONCEPT CAPACITY
276 passengers

PROPULSION
4 next-generation supersonic turbofans

CRUISE ALTITUDE
60,000 - 70,000 ft

THE PREMIUM PRODUCT

01 SIGNATURE CABIN

A calm, private-feeling environment designed around spacious seating, lighting and restorative comfort.

02 DUBAI FAST-TRACK

Premium ground handling, dedicated transfer assistance and priority departure/arrival flows, subject to airport agreements.

03 TIME BACK

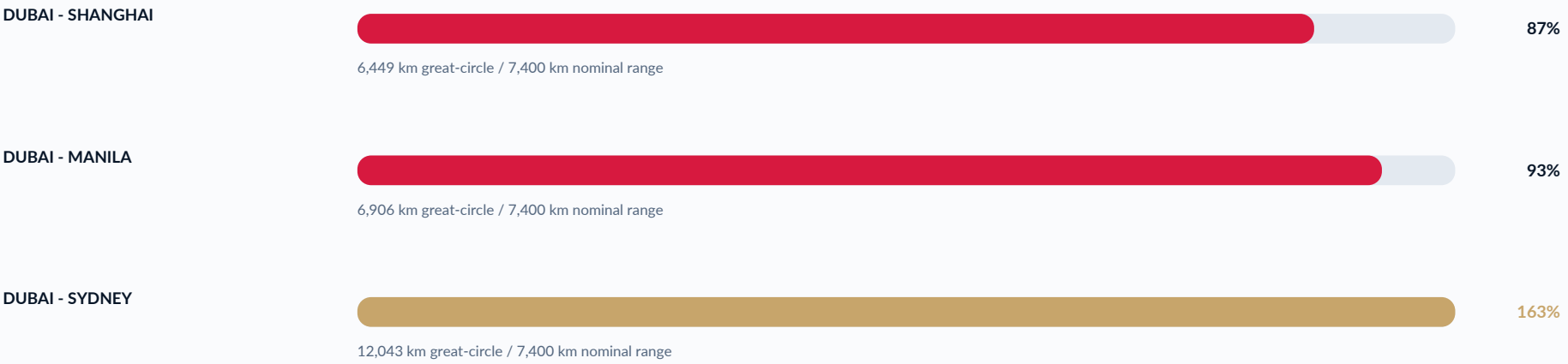
A time-saving proposition for executives, entrepreneurs, creative leaders and travellers who value the day at destination.

Interior configuration, service classes, seating density and payload-range trade-offs require detailed engineering and commercial validation.

ENGINEERING THE NETWORK

DESIGN THE ROUTE AROUND THE RANGE

A 7,400 km headline range is a useful concept reference - it is not a promise that every mission is operationally viable at full payload.



EVALUATE FIRST

SHANGHAI

The distance fits inside the nominal range, but payload, winds, alternate planning, fuel reserves and permitted supersonic segments must be proven.

PROVE THE MARGINS

MANILA

The nominal range margin is small. Initial operations may require payload limits, enhanced performance or a higher-range variant.

BUILD THE LONG-RANGE CASE

SYDNEY

Target a range-extended derivative around 13,500 km, or stage a connected service through Singapore on the baseline concept.

Staged Sydney option: Dubai - Singapore ≈ 5,845 km, then Singapore - Sydney ≈ 6,294 km. Both legs are within the headline 7,400 km range on a simple distance comparison, but each still needs full fuel-reserve, payload, diversion and operating-profile analysis.

FROM AMBITION TO SERVICE

A CREDIBLE PATH TO THE FIRST FLIGHT

A staged programme protects the brand promise: operational reliability and regulatory permission come before the headline speed.

01 ROUTE AND MISSION DEFINITION

Validate Dubai-Shanghai and Dubai-Manila mission profiles, reserve fuel, diversion airports, winds and high-speed corridor assumptions.

02 AIRCRAFT AND RANGE PROOF

Substantiate performance at representative payloads; verify engine, thermal, structural, cabin and maintenance requirements at Mach 2.2.

03 NOISE, EMISSIONS AND CERTIFICATION

Engage UAE, destination states and relevant certification authorities; prove airport noise and en-route boom compliance.

04 PREMIUM DEMONSTRATION SERVICE

Launch only once certified, using a limited schedule and a high-touch customer offer; expand on measured reliability and route economics.

THE NON-NEGOTIABLES

AIRSPACE

A Mach 2.2 cruise target only translates into time savings where supersonic operation is authorised. Land and terminal segments may require lower speeds.

SONIC BOOM

ICAO continues work on an en-route sonic-boom certification scheme; national rules and operational permissions must be mapped route by route.

NOISE + EMISSIONS

The March 2026 ICAO announcement reinforces the evolving environmental standard-setting environment for next-generation aircraft.

CLAIMS CONTROL

All times in this brochure are speculative targets. The supplied 7,400 km range, 276-seat capacity and Mach 2.2 are concept-art figures, not certified data.

PUBLISHED NONSTOP REFERENCE TIMES

Sydney: emirates.com/english/destinations/dxb/syd/flights-from-dubai-to-sydney/ | Shanghai: emirates.com/english/destinations/dxb/pvg/flights-from-dubai-to-shanghai/ | Manila: emirates.com/english/destinations/dxb/mnl/flights-from-dubai-to-manila/

SELECTED REFERENCES

ICAO - Supersonic Aircraft Noise Standards Development (ongoing en-route boom and take-off/landing certification): icao.int/environmental-protection/supersonic-aircraft-noise-standards-development

ICAO - New aircraft will face stricter environmental standards, 27 Mar 2026: icao.int/news/new-aircraft-will-face-stricter-environmental-standards

FAA - Enabling Supersonic Overland Flight, proposed rule, 2 Jul 2026 (US example): federalregister.gov, document 2026-13440